

Items for experiments 1 and 2 of the project '**Intentionality, speaker's attitude and the processing of verbal irony**'

Every item shows four versions (one per condition) along with the comprehension question asked

1.

(-1) negative bias

Jennifer lost her debit card at a concert and has to go to the bank to get a new one. At the bank, the very annoyed Manager tells her that it is absolutely necessary to show her driver's license and no other type of I.D. before he can issue a new card for her. Jennifer also lost her driver's license at the concert. She goes through her purse to look for another I.D. card. Jennifer asks: "Sorry, could I show you my library card instead?"

(0) No bias

Jennifer lost her gym card recently and wants to get a new one made for her. She runs out the house and takes the subway to get to the gym's office before they close, which she is able to make. The manager, who was just on his way out, asks Jennifer to show him her driver's license to prove who she is. She thinks for a second and then goes through her purse looking for it. Jennifer then asks: "Sorry, could I show you my library card instead?"

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

The manager enjoys poking fun of customers. He thus replies: "Yes, Library cards are convincing documents."

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

The manager is famous for his straight sense of honesty. He thus replies: "Yes, library cards are convincing documents."

[wrap up sentence]

While they talked, it started to rain heavily.

[question]

The manager is going to: ["demand to see a better form of ID", "issue a new card for Jennifer", "Go to a concert"]

2

(-1) negative bias

Jonah and Samantha are on a first date at an exclusive French restaurant. Jonah forgot that Samantha is a die-hard vegetarian when making the reservations. He goes to talk to Pierre, the very snooty restaurant manager, to change the meat-heavy 3-course meal that he had ordered in advance. The restaurant does not offer any vegetarian options and Pierre hates meddling customers. Jonah says to him: "Could we change our order to a Tofu-based dish?"

(0) No bias

Jonah and Samantha are having lunch at a restaurant close to their children's school. They were just there helping out with the upcoming science fair. They are sitting on the restaurant's terrace enjoying their one hour break away from the kids. After putting in their orders, Jonah has a sudden change of heart and goes to talk to Pierre, the waiter, who was already heading for the kitchen. Jonah says to him: "Could we change our order to a Tofu-based dish?"

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

Pierre is known for always teasing his customers. He therefore answers: "Yes, Tofu really adds tremendous flavor to any dish."

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

Pierre is known for being truthful to his customers. He therefore answers: ““Yes, Tofu really adds tremendous flavor to any dish.”

[wrap up sentence]

The restaurant was particularly busy at that time.

[question]

Pierre is going to: ["change the order to a tofu dish", "refuse to change the order", "Eat tofu"]

3

(-1) negative bias

Joan is in England and is traveling back to the U.S.A. in two days, but her passport has expired. She was supposed to renew it months ago, but instead she waited until the last minute to go to the American consulate, despite having read that it takes weeks to get a new passport. Here she meets Sandra, a low-level bureaucrat, who is bored to death with the monotony of her job. Sandra hates it when people try to get exceptions made for them because she does not have the power to make them. Joan asks Sandra: “So, will I be able to catch my flight?”

(0) No bias

Joan is in England and is traveling back to the U.S.A soon, but she can't find her passport. She called the American consulate and explained the situation, to which they told her to come by in person. Sandra, the person in charge, was not in the office when Joan came, so she had to sit and wait for her for 2 hours. After that, she was asked to step into Sandra's office. Joan asks Sandra: “So, will I be able to catch my flight?”

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

Sandra always tells visitors a joke to break the ice. This is why she says to her: “ Yes, let me call the airline and vouch for you”.

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

Sandra always tells visitors the truth to avoid mix-ups. This is why she says to her: ” Yes, let me call the airline and vouch for you“

[wrap up sentence]

The consulate was relatively empty that morning.

[question]

Joan is probably going to: ["travel according to her original plan", "stay in London until she gets a new passport", "Get a job in the consulate"]

4.

(-1) negative bias

Kate works at an office downtown and she sometimes goes to a fancy restaurant for lunch. Seth, who is new at the job, is serving her, and her attitude comes across as entitled and snooty. Upon reaching in her purse, Kate realized that she didn't have any money on her to pay for her lunch. The restaurant has a strict no-credit policy, so Seth would have to pay for the meal himself in case Kate doesn't pay. Kate then says to Seth: “Sorry, could I pay for lunch some

other time?"

(0) No bias

Kate works at a law firm downtown and she often goes to a diner for lunch that's a couple of blocks away from her office. She really likes it because no one else from work has lunch there, so she gets some peace and quiet after the morning's meetings. Seth works at that diner and is serving Kate. After ordering she realized that she left her wallet in the office. Kate then says to Seth: "Sorry, could I pay for lunch some other time?"

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

Seth always relies on his humor to deal with customers. This is why he replies: "Yes, I would definitely love to pay for your meal myself".

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

Seth always insists on being truthful to those around him. This is why he replies: "Yes, I would definitely love to pay for your meal myself".

[wrap up sentence]

The daily special was very expensive on that day.

[question]

Seth will: ["pay for the meal himself", "Not let her pay some other time", "Quit his job"]

5.

(-1) negative bias

Chris wants to buy his five-year-old daughter her first guitar. They go to a professional music shop together and she heads for the oldest and most valuable guitar in the store, which was behind a protective glass case. As she comes closer, one can see that the guitar is twice her size. The owner of the store, who really hates children, sees this and anxiously walks towards them. Chris sees him and says: "Sorry, could my daughter play this guitar?"

(0) No bias

Chris wants to buy his 15-year-old daughter a new guitar, so they go to a music shop together. She is overwhelmed by all the different types of guitars they have, so she doesn't know which one to pick. They browse around for a while, and finally she finds one that she really likes, even though Chris doesn't understand why. He starts looking for the owner to ask him about it. Chris sees him and says: "Sorry, could my daughter play this guitar?"

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

The owner has a reputation for being a jokester. He therefore replies: "Yes, this guitar is here for everyone to play with."

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

The owner has a reputation for being frank. He therefore replies: "Yes, this guitar is here for everyone to play with."

[wrap up sentence]

The store was absolutely full of music enthusiasts.

[question]

The owner will: ["not let her play the guitar", "let her play the guitar", "Buy a guitar"]

6.

(-1) negative bias

Isabel and Ethan are roommates. Ethan is bad with money and is always asking his friends for a loan, despite the fact that his wealthy parents support him financially. He usually spends the money on terrible investments, and is now looking for cash for a new project. Isabel is really sick of seeing Ethan throw so much money away, especially since she barely has any money herself. Ethan says to her: "Do you want to go into business together?"

(0) No bias

Isabel and Ethan are friends and hang out every so often. Ethan had his heart set on buying his nephew an Xbox, but he can't really afford it at the moment. He knows that Isabel has put away some money, so he decides to talk to her about it over coffee. They meet up at a café that they both really like, and after an hour or so, he decides to ask her about it. Ethan says to her: "Could I borrow some cash for my nephew's gift?"

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

Isabel is known for being sarcastic with her friends. This is why she says to him: "Yes, this sounds like a great use of my savings."

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

Isabel is known for being truthful with her friends. This is why she says to him: "Yes, this sounds like a great use of my savings."

[wrap up sentence]

Asking friends for money can be a complicated affair.

[question]

Ethan is going to: ["get some money from Isabel", "not get any money from Isabel", "Lend money to Isabel"]

7.

(-1) negative bias

Philipp plays the trombone in his school's band together with Jack, who is struggling to keep up and could really use some help. Jack decides to talk to Philipp about it while Philipp is practicing his scales. There is a competitive environment in the band, since they are all at risk of being kicked out, so nobody ever helps anyone else. Jack approaches him: "Hey, would you help me with my solo?"

(0) No bias

Philipp plays the trombone in his school's band together with Jack, who is struggling to keep up and could really use some help. Jack decides to talk to Philipp about it while Philipp is practicing his scales. Jack is a bit embarrassed about asking, especially since he and Philipp have never actually spoken before. Philipp looks like he is struggling with his scales. Jack approaches him: "Hey, would you help me with my solo?"

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

Philipp is famous for being very sarcastic. This is why he answers: "Yes, I will drop what I'm doing and help you out".

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

Philipp is famous for being very honest. This is why he answers: “ Yes, I will drop what I’m doing and help you out.”
[wrap up sentence]

Playing an instrument requires a lot of practice

[question]

Jack is going to: ["not get help from Philipp", "get help from Philipp", "help Philipp"]

8.

(-1) negative bias

Claudia is a PhD student and she has a really close work relationship with her mentor and advisor, Dr. Jenkins. Claudia admires him deeply, and he wants to have her as a faculty member after she graduates. Recently a reporter from a tabloid dug up some dirt on Dr. Jenkins, and she calls Claudia to ask for assistance. If it gets published, it will probably cost Dr. Jenkins his job. The reporter asks straight on: “Would you help us take Dr. Jenkins down?”

(0) No bias

Claudia is a PhD student and she has a somewhat distant relationship with her advisor, Dr. Jenkins. She feels like he doesn't have enough time to answer all of her questions, which is frustrating. A reporter from a tabloid dug up some dirt on Dr. Jenkins, and, knowing that Claudia works for him, she calls her to ask for assistance. If this gets published, it could damage Dr. Jenkins' reputation. The reporter asks straight on: “Would you help us take Dr. Jenkins down?”

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

Claudia never misses an opportunity to be funny: “Yes, I will definitely help end my professor’s career.”

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

Claudia never beats around the bush. She therefore says: “Yes, I will definitely help end my professor’s career.”

[wrap up sentence]

Tabloids are among the most read newspapers in the world.

[question]

Claudia is going to: ["Not helpt the reporter", "Help the reporter", "Get help from the reporter"]

9.

(-1) negative bias

Will and his brother Spence want to go to a very hip bar that is very selective about who they let in. Both of them are noticeably under age but decide to try their luck anyway. The bouncer, who doesn't understand why people keep trying to pull the same trick, can clearly see what they are trying to do and starts shaking his head. They walk up to him with confidence. Will says to him: “Hello, could we enter your establishment?”

(0) No bias

Will and his friend Spence want to go to a new club that opened up in their neighborhood. They decide to go there on Friday night after work to see what the hype is all about. The bouncer of the club sees them and thinks that they are under-dressed, but that they still look kind of cool. When they get to the front of the line the bouncer gives them a piercing look. Will says to him: “Hello, could we enter your establishment?”

[target sentence,insincere attitude]

The bouncer has a reputation for constantly pulling everyone's leg. Because of this, he answers: " Yes, you are exactly the type of clientele we like to have. "

[target sentence, sincere attitude]

The bouncer has a reputation for constantly saying exactly what he means. Because of this, he answers "Yes, you are exactly the type of clientele we like to have."

[wrap up sentence]

The people standing in line behind Will and Spence were starting to get impatient.

[question]

Spence and Will are going to: ["be sent back", "be allowed into the club", "Get a job at the bar"]